

Students are advised to retain course outlines for future use in support of applications for employment or transfer of credits.

Instructor

McGraw, Naomi

Room

A3011

Availability

Available Monday – Friday (8:30-4:30) via email & during lab classes

Email

naomi.mcgraw@nbcc.ca

Program Title

_GCD Graphic Design 2026 - 2028 (Fall Intake)

Campus(es) being delivered to:

NBCC Moncton Campus

Delivery Mode

Blended Delivery

Period of Delivery

Fall 2026 (From 2026-09-08 to 2026-10-23)

Classroom

A3020

Course Schedule

Monday: 10:30 – 12:30

Wednesday: 8:30 – 10:30

Friday: 8:30 – 10:30

Credits

3

Grading Basis

Graded

Pass mark

60%

Description

This course is designed to build learners' creative thinking and problem-solving skills through curiosity, user-centered approaches, and teamwork. Learners explore basic drawing skills as well as design thinking tools and processes, in order to conceive and draft preliminary visual design solutions.

Course Outcome

Explore creative methods and processes to conceive and draft traditional, hand-drawn visual design solutions.

Competencies

The following competencies will be achieved:

1. define the design problem and the desired outcome for the design solution
2. analyze user needs and perspectives thoroughly
 - 2.1. research the prospective project, client and competitors
 - 2.2. collect supporting materials
3. utilize problem-solving tools such as brainstorming, teamwork, mind-mapping, focus groups, etc.
4. employ quick renderings and basic drawing techniques to demonstrate design concepts
5. produce rough sketches and comprehensives to illustrate design concepts
6. examine existing design solutions

Essential Skills

Participation in the learning activities related to this course will reinforce the development of essential skills such as the following:

1. Communicate
 - 1.1. Write, speak and share information using a variety of media so others understand (e.g., face-to-face, telephone, e-mail, computer applications)
2. Manage Information
 - 2.1. Access, gather, organize and interpret information using appropriate information systems and technology with the accuracy required to complete tasks
3. Think and Solve Problems
 - 3.1. Identify problems by assessing situations that recognize the human, interpersonal, technical, scientific, and/or mathematical dimensions

Activities / Assessments**Participation (10 %)****Weight(%)****Self-Evaluation:****10**

For your participation grade, you will complete a self-evaluation quiz at the end of the term. This quiz covers your participation, attendance, professional ethics, attitude, communication methods, classroom interaction, behaviour, and preparedness. Your instructor may raise or lower points based on classroom observations. The purpose of this self-evaluation is to help you reflect honestly on your own professionalism.

In the workplace, you're often expected to recognize your own strengths and areas for improvement without being told directly. By practicing this skill now, you learn to take ownership of your performance—just as you'll be expected to do in a professional setting. If you do not complete the self-evaluation, you will receive a zero (0), as this is the grade you have chosen for yourself. The instructor may raise or lower the grade based on observations in the classroom.

Due Dates:

You will be asked to complete this self-assessment via quiz by the end of the term:

Oct 23 @11:59 pm

Drawing (15 %)**Weight(%)****Drawing Exercises****15**

You will complete a variety of drawing exercises designed to introduce pencil-to-paper brainstorming and quick idea renderings. These activities focus on translating concepts onto paper and developing problem-solving skills useful across all design work.

Each exercise will be graded to make up 15% of your final grade and assessed on creativity, effort, and attention to detail—not drawing technique. In the design industry, most work is digital, but creativity is the essential skill you'll build through these exercises.

Due Dates:

All Exercises are due by the end of class

Drawing Exercise #1 – Sept 14 @12:30 pm

Drawing Exercise #2 – Sept 21 @12:30 pm

Drawing Exercise #3 – Sept 28 @12:30 pm

*All Due dates are tentative and subject to change

Research (25 %)**Weight(%)****About:**

Throughout this course, you will practice the foundational steps of working with a mock client who needs design support, beginning with research and communication. These assignments lay the groundwork for future design courses, as understanding a client's needs is one of the most important aspects of successful design. Work will be assessed through a Q&A format, with grades based on the quality and relevance of your research, observations, comparisons, visuals, and ability to connect your findings to the client's design needs.

The competencies covered are:

- define the design problem and the desired outcome for the design solution
- analyze user needs and perspectives thoroughly

Research #1 – Company Research**10**

You will research your assigned client, competitors, and other brands for inspiration. Assessment will focus on the quality and relevance of your research, your observations and comparisons, use of supporting visuals and sources, and your ability to identify insights that could inform the client's design direction.

Research #2 – Creative Brief**15**

After completing your research, you will create a brief summarizing your findings and establishing a clear direction for the project. Assessment will focus on your ability to bring your research together, clearly identify the client's goals, challenges, audience, and design needs, and develop relevant questions and recommendations to help guide the design process.

Due Dates:

Both Research Assignments are due by the end of the day (midnight)

Research #1 – Sept 11 @11:59 pm

Research #2 – Sept 18 @11:59 pm

*All Due dates are tentative and subject to change

Project (40 %)**Weight(%)****About:**

For your course project, you will use your assigned client and the research you conducted to develop a new brand direction through a step-by-step design process. The project includes brainstorming, moodboards, sketches, and a comprehensive final design. Each stage builds on the previous one and is equally important to the development of a successful design. The four project parts are worth 10% each and will be assessed on your ability to develop ideas, apply research and inspiration, explore and refine design solutions, and create designs that respond to the client's needs.

The competencies covered are:

- utilize problem-solving tools such as brainstorming, teamwork, mind-mapping, focus groups, etc.
- employ quick renderings and basic drawing techniques to demonstrate design concepts
- produce rough sketches and comprehensives to illustrate design concepts
- examine existing design solutions

Part #1: Brainstorming

10

You will generate ideas through mind mapping and thumbnail sketches. Work will be assessed on the quantity and variety of ideas, creativity, exploration, and your ability to combine words and concepts into visual ideas.

Part #2: Moodboards

10

You will collect visual inspiration to establish a focused direction for the brand, including fonts, colours, logos, business cards, merchandise, and mockups. Work will be assessed on the relevance and variety of your inspiration, creativity, effort, and how effectively your moodboards communicate a clear visual direction for the client.

Part #3: Sketches

10

You will develop your ideas into sketches for the logo, merchandise, business cards, and mockups, using your moodboards as guides and inspiration. Work will be assessed on creative exploration, variety, attention to detail, and how effectively you apply your moodboard direction to your design ideas.

Part #4: Comprehensive

10

Following your client meeting, you will refine your ideas into one finalized logo and one comprehensive mockup drawing that communicate the overall look and feel of the brand. You will also submit a short reflection discussing your design choices and comparing your solution to existing designs. Work will be assessed on quality, attention to detail, effective use of client feedback, clarity of the final design, and your ability to reflect critically on how well your solution addresses the client's needs.

Due Dates:

All Parts of the Project are due by the end of the day (midnight)

Project Part #1 – Sept 25 @11:59 pm

Project Part #2 – Oct 2 @11:59 pm

Project Part #3 – Oct 9 @11:59 pm

Project Part #4 – Oct 23 @11:59 pm

*All Due dates are tentative and subject to change

Presentation (10 %)**Weight(%)****Client meeting**

10

Following Parts 1–3 of your project, you will meet with the instructor (acting as a mock-client) to practice presenting your ideas, receiving feedback, and understanding the project scope. This will prepare you for Part 4 by helping refine your final design. You will be assessed on your ability to present professionally and clearly, communicate your strategy and design choices, listen and respond effectively to feedback, stay organized and calm, and follow up appropriately. Students are graded on professionalism, clarity, communication, and engagement with client feedback.

Due Dates:

During the last two weeks of the term, you will be asked to book a time slot to meet with your mock client. Available meeting times are as follows:

- Wednesday, Oct 14 – 8:30–10:30
- Friday, Oct 16 – 8:30–10:30
- Monday, Oct 9 – 10:30-12:30

Other**Weight(%)**

AI: Semi-Restricted (Citations)

Academic integrity is a core principle at NBCC, and all students must uphold this principle, whether using AI-based tools or otherwise. For my class, responsible use of AI-based tools in completing coursework or assessments must be done per the following:

1. You must clearly identify the use of AI-based tools in your work. Any work that utilizes AI-based tools must be clearly marked as such, including the specific tool(s) used.
2. You must be transparent in how you used the AI-based tool, including what work is your original contribution. An AI detector such as GPTZero (<https://gptzero.me/>) may be used to detect AI-driven work.
3. You must ensure that using AI-based tools does not violate copyright or intellectual property laws.
4. You must not use AI-based tools to cheat on assessments.
5. You must not use AI-based tools to plagiarize without citation.

Required Resources

Laptop (with webcam/mic), Adobe Creative Cloud, Pencil & Paper, access to the internet & MS Teams.

NBCC is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold NBCC's policy concerning Academic Integrity. The plagiarism detection tool, Turnitin, is integrated into Brightspace and may be used.

Remote proctoring using Respondus Monitor and LockDown Browser, may also be used to ensure academic integrity of assessments. Alternate testing arrangements may be arranged in advance (i.e. live proctoring on campus).

Approved Electronically

Mary Lynn Jardine

Date

2026-09-06

NBCC promotes transparency in the application of its policies and procedures. Subsequently, numerous policies that apply to students can be viewed at <https://documents.nbcc.ca/>. Policies and procedures are regularly reviewed and updated. Please be sure to check the site regularly for the most up-to-date document.

Course Delivery and Evaluation of Learning NBCC is committed to ensuring quality delivery and evaluation methods in its courses and programs while providing supports and assisting students in achieving success, recognizing that there are circumstances when an unsuccessful grade may not reflect student learning. A Supplemental Evaluation Measure may be offered to students who receive an unsuccessful grade in a credit course, provided necessary criteria are met.

Grading and Academic Recognition NBCC uses a grading/credit system to indicate course grades which are translated to a transcript of marks that reflects the history of the student's academic progression and performance.

Academic Integrity NBCC is committed to promoting academic integrity throughout the college community. Academic honesty and integrity are fundamental expectations and requirements of students as they assume responsibility for their learning and actions.

Student Code of Conduct NBCC believes that learning in an adult education setting offers holistic development of the learner. A climate of collaboration and respect of self, of others and of established rules and regulations is the setting by which an effective environment of learning is established.

Accessibility Services NBCC will provide reasonable accommodation to students with disabilities in order to promote academic success. If you feel you may require accommodations or other forms of support while at NBCC, please talk to a Learning Strategist at your campus.

College Office of Research Enterprise (CORE) NBCC encourages incorporating research into course activities to enrich the learning experience. When research activities involve human participants, instructors should contact reb@nbcc.ca for guidance on when research ethics review is required, and how to apply.

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